Why join the Democratic Socialists of America?

A better world is possible.

Together we can make it real. Your Baton Rouge chapter of the Democratic Socialists of America is building a better world where we live. Learn more at **brdsa.org**

How do we practice democracy?

Every member has a say in what we do. All major decisions are brought to a vote by members. Everyone is encouraged to bring proposals, and have a say (whether for or against!) any proposal. We may have different views on how we reach our shared goals, which is ok! Every opinion deserves to be heard.

Why pay dues?

Dues help fund our work and support the national organizing infrastructure. DSA is **member-funded**, meaning every member contributes monthly or yearly. This means there are no billionaires or dark-money groups running DSA behind the scenes. Plus, joining the Baton Rouge chapter gets you this cool shirt!

Why be a member?

Every chapter is run by its members. It's empowering, builds knowledge and skills, and demonstrates the **power of organized people**. Your chapter is yours, because decisions are made democratically and your comrades are there to support and develop your ideas.

What does it mean to be a member?

There are lots of ways to be a member! Not everyone has a lot of spare time on their hands. Working people typically have little say about our schedules (thanks, bosses). Whether you're organizing in the labor movement, or bringing your world-famous oatmeal raisin cookies to a social, **everyone's contributions are important**. What matters is you're learning from each other and making decisions together.

Why DSA?

The Democratic Socialists of America (DSA) is the largest socialist organization in the USA! We are not beholden to any corporate/big money donors, which means **you get to chart the work and make it your own**, unlike other orgs who are guided by an outside agenda. **Democracy is power!**

Why socialism?

Under capitalism (the current economic system), billionaires and bosses have all the control because they accumulate wealth by **exploiting the working class** for our time and labor. There is a major imbalance of power, and they need you more than you need them.

Under socialism, **workers will have control over how our workplaces and our government are run**, and we will only be accountable to each other. DSA is fighting for a world FOR the people, BY the people.